

BSF-OPS-004 — Seafood Receiving and Inspection Procedure

Field	Detail
Document Code	BSF-OPS-004
Document Title	Seafood Receiving and Inspection Procedure
Keywords	seafood receiving; incoming inspection; supplier approval; vessel authorization; temperature control; organoleptic inspection; HACCP; cold chain; traceability; product hold; rejection; corrective action; BRCGS Food Safety; IFS Food; MSC Chain of Custody; BASC; SMETA; ISO 9001
Document Type	Operations Procedure
Business Area	Operations
Process Owner	Operations Manager
Functional Approvers	Quality Assurance Manager; Food Safety Coordinator; Procurement Coordinator; Traceability Officer; Supply Chain Security Coordinator
Applicable Sites	BSF receiving docks, processing plants, cold storage areas, external receiving points under BSF control, approved third-party warehouses, and any site where seafood is received, inspected, accepted, rejected, or placed on hold
Source Review Format	Markdown
Target Export Format	PDF
Status	Draft for Review
Version	1.0
Effective Date	To be confirmed upon approval

Field	Detail
Review Frequency	Annual or earlier if supplier, species, process, legal, customer, certification, temperature, security, traceability, or food safety requirements change
Confidentiality Level	Internal Use Only

1. Purpose

The purpose of this procedure is to define how BSF receives, verifies, inspects, accepts, rejects, records, and controls seafood products at the point of receipt. The procedure establishes a consistent method for confirming that incoming seafood complies with purchase requirements, approved supplier conditions, authorized vessel requirements, species specifications, temperature limits, freshness criteria, traceability requirements, food safety controls, certification claims, cargo security controls, and applicable legal or customer requirements.

Receiving is one of the most critical control points in BSF’s operational system. Once seafood is accepted into BSF custody, the company becomes responsible for maintaining product identity, quality, food safety, certified status, cold-chain integrity, and reliable records. For that reason, no incoming lot shall be released to storage, processing, sale, export preparation, or customer allocation until the minimum receiving and inspection checks defined in this procedure have been completed and recorded.

This procedure supports the prevention of:

- Acceptance of product from unapproved suppliers or unauthorized vessels.
- Loss of traceability or incorrect lot identification.
- Acceptance of product outside temperature requirements.
- Mislabeling or species substitution.
- Acceptance of damaged, contaminated, decomposed, adulterated, or unsafe product.
- Acceptance of product with incomplete legal, sanitary, harvest, transport, or certification documentation.
- Breaks in MSC Chain of Custody or other customer-specific certification claims.
- Cargo security weaknesses affecting BASC-related controls.
- Delays in identifying nonconforming product and applying corrective action.

2. Scope

This procedure applies to all seafood raw material, semi-processed product, frozen product, chilled product, packed product, samples, returns, transfers, and customer-directed product received by BSF or by third parties operating under BSF instruction.

It applies to:

- Fresh seafood delivered directly from landing points, vessels, farms, suppliers, brokers, consolidators, or approved transporters.
- Frozen seafood delivered by refrigerated truck, reefer container, cold storage transfer, or approved logistics provider.
- Chilled seafood requiring controlled temperature handling.
- Products covered by MSC Chain of Custody, BRCGS Food Safety, IFS Food, HACCP, customer standards, export requirements, or internal specifications.
- Product received for processing, storage, repacking, inspection, sampling, export preparation, customer allocation, or evaluation.
- Receiving activities performed by Operations, Quality Assurance, Food Safety, Procurement, Warehouse, Security, Traceability, and Logistics personnel.

This procedure does not replace supplier approval, product specification management, export documentation, corrective action procedures, recall procedures, laboratory testing methods, sanitation procedures, security procedures, or cold-chain monitoring instructions. When a more specific document applies, both documents shall be followed. If there is a conflict, the stricter food safety, legal, customer, certification, or traceability requirement shall apply.

3. Confidentiality

This document is classified as **Internal Use Only**. It may be shared with BSF employees, approved suppliers, auditors, certification bodies, customers, regulators, logistics providers, and contractors when there is a legitimate business need.

The following information generated through this procedure shall be controlled as confidential:

- Supplier performance results.
- Vessel authorization status.
- Lot-level inspection results.
- Rejection records and nonconformity details.
- Product-hold decisions.

- Certification claims and traceability documents.
- Customer-specific specifications.
- Security incident observations.
- Commercial purchase terms, volumes, prices, and allocation decisions.
- Photographs or evidence related to product quality, cargo condition, seals, labels, or documentation discrepancies.

Personnel shall not disclose receiving results, supplier findings, product defects, cargo security concerns, laboratory results, customer claims, or certification status to unauthorized parties. External communication related to rejected product, legal reporting, product safety concerns, customer notification, or supplier escalation shall be coordinated through the responsible manager.

4. Compliance and Standards Alignment

This procedure supports the standards and reference frameworks included in BSF’s corporate documentation program.

Framework or Requirement Area	Relevance to Seafood Receiving and Inspection
ISO 9001	Supports controlled receiving processes, supplier-related controls, documented information, acceptance criteria, nonconforming output control, performance evaluation, corrective action, and continual improvement.
HACCP	Supports hazard prevention at receiving, including temperature abuse, contamination, decomposition, species risk, histamine risk, foreign matter, allergen exposure, and supplier control.
BRCGS Food Safety	Supports raw material approval, supplier management, traceability, product inspection, product release, nonconforming product control, site standards, and documented evidence.
IFS Food	Supports incoming goods controls, supplier approval, specifications, product safety, traceability, risk-based inspection, corrective action, and records.
MSC Chain of Custody	Supports verification of certified status, eligible supplier or vessel source, segregation, identification, labeling, and traceability of certified seafood.

Framework or Requirement Area	Relevance to Seafood Receiving and Inspection
BASC	Supports cargo security, seal control, transport inspection, access control, documentation verification, and reporting of suspicious or unauthorized activities.
SMETA	Supports safe working conditions during unloading, fair labor expectations in supplier engagement, worker safety, emergency readiness, and responsible business practices.
Local legal and sanitary requirements	Supports compliance with landing, transport, sanitary, temperature, labeling, documentation, inspection, export, and traceability obligations applicable to seafood.

This procedure is intended to provide internal operating instructions and does not reproduce external standards in full. Where customer or regulatory requirements are stricter than this procedure, the stricter requirement shall be followed and documented.

5. Definitions

Term	Definition
Receiving	The process of physically accepting an incoming shipment or lot into BSF custody after document, condition, temperature, identity, and quality checks.
Incoming Lot	A defined quantity of seafood received under common supplier, vessel, harvest, delivery, species, presentation, date, transport, certification, or traceability characteristics.
Approved Supplier	A supplier that has been evaluated and authorized under BSF supplier approval requirements.
Authorized Vessel	A vessel listed as eligible in BSF-OPS-002 — Authorized Fishing Vessels or otherwise approved by Procurement and QA before receipt.
Species Catalog	The controlled list of species, scientific names, risk classification, temperature expectations, presentation, and certification applicability in BSF-OPS-003 — Seafood Species Catalog.

Term	Definition
Organoleptic Inspection	Evaluation of product quality using sensory indicators such as odor, appearance, texture, color, eyes, gills, slime, flesh condition, freezer burn, glaze, dehydration, and signs of decomposition.
Temperature Check	Measurement and recording of product, surface, core, vehicle, or ambient temperature according to product type and risk.
Product Hold	Temporary restriction preventing product use, processing, release, movement, sale, export, or allocation until an authorized decision is made.
Nonconforming Product	Product that does not meet specification, legal, food safety, temperature, documentation, traceability, certification, security, or customer requirements.
Acceptance Criteria	The minimum requirements that must be met before product may be accepted into BSF inventory or processing flow.
Rejection	Formal refusal of product due to failure to meet mandatory requirements or unacceptable risk.
Conditional Acceptance	Temporary acceptance under defined restrictions, usually requiring QA approval, product hold, corrective action, additional documentation, testing, rework, sorting, or customer authorization.
Chain of Custody	The documented and controlled flow of product identity, segregation, certification status, and traceability from source to final output.
Seal Integrity	Verification that transport seals, locks, access points, and cargo compartments have not been altered, broken, or tampered with outside authorized control.

6. Receiving Principles

BSF shall manage seafood receiving according to the following principles:

Principle	Requirement
No approval, no receipt	Product shall not be accepted from unapproved suppliers or unauthorized vessels unless a documented exception is approved by Procurement and QA.

Principle	Requirement
Food safety first	Product that presents a food safety risk shall be placed on hold or rejected, even if commercial pressure exists to accept it.
Traceability before movement	Lot identity, supplier, species, source, date, and certification status shall be verified before the product is released to storage or processing.
Cold chain protection	Product temperature and receiving time shall be controlled to prevent temperature abuse.
Evidence-based decision	Acceptance, rejection, conditional acceptance, and hold decisions shall be supported by records, measurements, photographs where useful, and authorized signatures.
Segregation of risk	Product with pending, unclear, nonconforming, or disputed status shall be physically and systemically segregated.
Certification integrity	Certified seafood shall not be mixed, relabeled, downgraded, upgraded, or claimed without verified evidence.
Security awareness	Unusual cargo, seal discrepancies, unauthorized access, suspicious documents, or tampering signs shall be escalated immediately.

7. Roles and Responsibilities

7.1 Operations Manager

The Operations Manager is responsible for ensuring that receiving areas, personnel, equipment, unloading capacity, cold-chain resources, and shift controls are available to apply this procedure. The Operations Manager ensures that product flow does not bypass inspection, product hold, or QA release requirements.

7.2 Quality Assurance Manager

The Quality Assurance Manager is responsible for defining inspection criteria, approving acceptance decisions for quality or food safety exceptions, reviewing nonconformities, authorizing product release from hold when appropriate, and ensuring that receiving controls support HACCP, BRCGS Food Safety, IFS Food, and customer requirements.

7.3 Food Safety Coordinator

The Food Safety Coordinator is responsible for reviewing receiving hazards, validating temperature and product safety criteria, advising on high-risk species or lots, coordinating testing where required, and escalating product safety concerns.

7.4 Receiving Supervisor

The Receiving Supervisor is responsible for coordinating unloading, checking readiness of the receiving area, ensuring personnel follow hygiene and safety rules, confirming documentation is collected, assigning inspectors, verifying that receiving records are completed, and ensuring that accepted, rejected, and held product are identified correctly.

7.5 Receiving Inspector or QA Inspector

The Receiving Inspector or QA Inspector is responsible for performing document checks, physical inspection, temperature checks, organoleptic evaluation, packaging condition review, label verification, sampling, record completion, and immediate reporting of deviations.

7.6 Procurement Coordinator

The Procurement Coordinator is responsible for confirming supplier approval, purchase order alignment, expected species, expected volumes, price or commercial terms where relevant, supplier corrective actions, and communication with suppliers when documentation or delivery conditions are incomplete.

7.7 Traceability Officer

The Traceability Officer is responsible for verifying lot coding, source information, species identity, certification status, MSC Chain of Custody evidence, supplier records, vessel identity, harvest or catch data, and system registration before product release.

7.8 Warehouse or Cold Storage Coordinator

The Warehouse or Cold Storage Coordinator is responsible for assigning storage location, maintaining segregation, controlling product movement, preserving cold-chain conditions, and ensuring that accepted or held product is stored according to status and temperature requirements.

7.9 Security Personnel

Security personnel are responsible for verifying vehicle access, driver identification, seal condition where applicable, cargo access points, suspicious behavior, restricted-area compliance, and immediate escalation of BASC-related concerns.

7.10 Employees, Contractors, and Visitors

All personnel involved in receiving shall follow safety, hygiene, PPE, access, product handling, and reporting requirements. Personnel shall not move, open, sample, relabel, rework, release, or dispose of product unless authorized.

8. Pre-Receiving Preparation

Before product arrival, the Receiving Supervisor shall confirm that the receiving area is ready.

Minimum preparation includes:

- Receiving dock or unloading area is clean, organized, and free from waste, pests, standing water, chemical exposure, unrelated materials, and blocked routes.
- Cold room, freezer, chilled staging area, or temporary controlled area is available.
- Scales, thermometers, probes, infrared thermometers, calibration references, sampling tools, inspection forms, labels, cameras, and PPE are available.
- Product hold tags, rejection tags, lot labels, and quarantine location are available.
- Personnel assigned to receiving understand expected delivery, product type, risk classification, and required checks.
- Required sanitation and hygiene conditions are in place.
- Unloading equipment is safe and operational.
- Security access has been coordinated if cargo, transport, or delivery timing requires controlled entry.
- System or manual receiving records are ready.

If the receiving area is not ready, the Receiving Supervisor shall delay unloading, use an approved alternative area, or escalate to Operations and QA. Product shall not be unloaded into an area that creates food safety, quality, security, or traceability risk.

9. Required Incoming Documentation

The following documents shall be requested and reviewed according to product type, supplier, origin, certification status, and customer requirements:

Document or Evidence	Minimum Check
Purchase order or delivery instruction	Product, supplier, quantity, delivery date, destination, and expected presentation match BSF requirements.
Delivery note, packing list, or invoice	Lot, boxes, weight, presentation, species, supplier, and shipment identification are consistent.
Supplier approval status	Supplier is approved or formally authorized by exception.
Vessel or source authorization	Vessel appears in BSF-OPS-002 — Authorized Fishing Vessels or source is otherwise approved.
Species information	Common name and scientific name match BSF-OPS-003 — Seafood Species Catalog and purchase specification.
Catch, harvest, landing, or production details	Date, area, batch, farm, vessel, landing site, or production site are complete where applicable.
Health or sanitary certificate	Present when required by regulation, customer, export, or internal rules.
Temperature record or transport log	Product and vehicle temperatures support cold-chain compliance.
MSC or certification evidence	Certified status is supported by valid documents and eligible supplier/source records.
Seal record	Seal number matches transport document and remains intact where seals are required.
Import/export or transfer documents	Required documents are complete for cross-border or controlled transfers.
Test results or declarations	Required histamine, microbiology, chemical, residue, allergen, or contaminant evidence is available where applicable.

Missing documentation does not automatically justify acceptance. If documentation is incomplete, inconsistent, altered, expired, unclear, or unavailable, the product shall be placed on hold until QA,

Procurement, and Traceability determine whether conditional acceptance, rejection, or further verification is appropriate.

10. Vehicle, Container, and Cargo Security Inspection

Before unloading, Security or Receiving personnel shall inspect the transport unit where applicable. Minimum checks include:

- Vehicle identification matches documentation.
- Driver identity is confirmed according to site access rules.
- Seal number matches the transport document.
- Seal is intact before opening.
- Cargo doors, locks, hinges, panels, and access points show no signs of tampering.
- Vehicle interior is clean, odor-free, dry where applicable, and free from pests, chemicals, fuel, unrelated cargo, or contamination risk.
- Refrigeration unit is operating where required.
- Temperature display, if available, is checked before opening.
- Product is protected from sun, rain, dust, pests, fumes, unauthorized handling, and excessive receiving delay.

If tampering, broken seals, suspicious cargo, unauthorized stops, unknown drivers, inconsistent routes, altered documents, or other security concerns are identified, the shipment shall not be fully released. The Receiving Supervisor shall notify Security, Operations, QA, and the Supply Chain Security Coordinator. Product may be placed on security hold pending investigation.

11. Product Identification and Traceability Verification

Before product is accepted into inventory, the receiving team shall verify that each lot can be traced. Minimum traceability elements include:

- Supplier name.
- Approved supplier code where applicable.
- Product description.
- Common name and scientific name.
- Species code or catalog reference.
- Lot, batch, landing, harvest, production, or shipment code.
- Delivery date and receiving time.
- Product presentation.

- Quantity received.
- Weight received.
- Origin, catch area, farm, vessel, or production site where required.
- Certification status, including MSC eligibility where applicable.
- Storage condition.
- Transport unit or container identification.
- Receiving inspector name.

If lot identity is unclear, product from different lots shall not be mixed. Product shall be segregated until identity is clarified. Any relabeling required to correct incomplete or unclear identification shall be approved by QA and Traceability and supported by evidence.

12. Temperature Control at Receiving

Temperature shall be checked immediately upon receipt or as soon as safely possible. The inspection method shall be appropriate to product type, packaging, risk, and legal/customer requirements.

Minimum checks may include:

- Vehicle or container temperature display.
- Ambient temperature inside the vehicle or cargo area.
- Product surface temperature.
- Product core temperature where practical and required.
- Temperature of representative boxes, pallets, totes, or zones.
- Temperature of product at highest-risk locations, such as door area, top layer, outside pallet, or product with visible thawing.
- Review of transport temperature records where available.

Temperature results shall be recorded in the receiving record or linked cold-chain record. The receiving team shall refer to BSF-OPS-001 — Cold Chain Control Register and product-specific specifications for applicable limits.

The following general decision logic applies:

Condition	Required Action
Temperature within required limit	Continue inspection and proceed with acceptance if all other criteria are met.

Condition	Required Action
Minor deviation with no evidence of product damage or food safety risk	Place product on hold or conditional acceptance pending QA review.
Significant deviation, thawing, decomposition indicators, safety concern, or unknown exposure time	Place product on hold and escalate to QA and Food Safety.
Temperature abuse creates unacceptable risk	Reject product or dispose according to authorized decision.
Certified product affected by temperature deviation	Maintain certification identity but restrict release until QA and Traceability assess status and claim impact.

Product shall not be accepted solely because it is commercially urgent. Temperature abuse shall be evaluated based on food safety, quality, exposure time, species risk, customer requirements, and applicable law.

13. Physical and Organoleptic Inspection

Incoming seafood shall be inspected using product-specific criteria. The Receiving Inspector or QA Inspector shall evaluate representative samples from the lot according to risk, quantity, supplier history, and product type.

Inspection shall consider:

- Product appearance.
- Odor.
- Texture.
- Color.
- Eyes, gills, skin, scales, shell, flesh, or exoskeleton condition where applicable.
- Presence of slime, discoloration, dehydration, freezer burn, bruising, belly burn, broken pieces, blood clots, parasites, foreign matter, excessive glaze, drip loss, or signs of decomposition.
- Packaging integrity.
- Label accuracy.
- Evidence of thawing and refreezing.
- Ice condition for chilled product.
- Cleanliness of containers, totes, pallets, liners, bags, cartons, and reusable packaging.

- Pest activity or contamination signs.
- Chemical, fuel, smoke, cleaning agent, or off-odor exposure.

The following indicators shall trigger QA escalation:

- Sour, ammonia-like, rancid, fuel-like, chemical, putrid, or abnormal odor.
- Soft, mushy, dry, slimy, broken-down, or abnormal texture.
- Unusual discoloration or decomposition signs.
- Excessive temperature deviation.
- Foreign matter or contamination.
- Excessive damage or leakage.
- Evidence of thawing in frozen product.
- Inconsistent species identity.
- Inconsistent label, certification, or origin claim.
- Signs of adulteration or substitution.
- Supplier history requiring increased inspection.

Where organoleptic evaluation suggests possible food safety risk, product shall be placed on hold pending QA decision. If required, samples shall be taken for laboratory testing.

14. Packaging, Labeling, and Quantity Verification

Packaging and labeling shall be checked before acceptance. Minimum checks include:

- Cartons, bags, totes, pallets, liners, and packaging are clean and intact.
- Packaging protects product from contamination and temperature abuse.
- Labels match product, species, lot, supplier, weight, presentation, storage condition, and certification claim.
- Net weight or gross weight aligns with purchase and delivery documents.
- Date codes, production codes, harvest dates, expiry dates, or best-before dates are present where required.
- Allergen or handling statements are present where required.
- MSC or certification labels are used only where supported by documentation.
- Damaged or unlabelled units are segregated and reviewed.

Quantity and weight differences shall be recorded. Material discrepancies shall be reported to Procurement and Operations. If weight differences suggest substitution, loss, tampering, undeclared thawing, water addition, glaze issue, or documentation inconsistency, QA shall be notified.

15. Sampling Requirements

Sampling shall be based on product type, risk level, supplier history, customer requirement, legal requirement, and QA instructions. Sampling may include:

- Visual inspection samples.
- Temperature samples.
- Sensory samples.
- Weight verification samples.
- Microbiological samples.
- Chemical or residue samples.
- Histamine samples for susceptible species.
- Species identification samples where risk of substitution exists.
- Retention samples where required by customer or internal policy.

Sampling tools shall be clean and suitable for food contact. Samples shall be identified with lot information and handled to preserve integrity. Sampling shall not compromise product safety or traceability. Any sample removed from a lot shall be recorded.

16. Acceptance, Conditional Acceptance, Hold, and Rejection

Receiving decisions shall be made according to documented evidence.

16.1 Acceptance

A lot may be accepted when:

- Supplier and source are approved.
- Documentation is complete and consistent.
- Product identity and species are verified.
- Temperature is within required limits or approved by QA after review.
- Product condition meets specification.
- Packaging and labels are acceptable.
- Traceability is complete.
- Certification claim is supported where applicable.
- No unresolved food safety, quality, legal, security, or customer issue exists.

Accepted product shall be labeled, recorded, and moved to approved storage or processing area without unnecessary delay.

16.2 Conditional Acceptance

Conditional acceptance may be allowed only with QA approval when the issue does not create unacceptable food safety, legal, certification, or customer risk. Examples include:

- Minor document correction pending supplier confirmation.
- Minor packaging damage with product unaffected.
- Minor temperature deviation with documented exposure assessment.
- Quantity discrepancy under review.
- Additional testing pending.
- Supplier corrective action required but product can remain controlled.

Conditionally accepted product shall remain clearly identified and may require hold, restricted use, sorting, rework, retesting, relabeling, downgraded use, or customer notification before release.

16.3 Product Hold

Product shall be placed on hold when:

- Acceptance criteria are not fully met.
- QA review is required.
- Documentation is incomplete or inconsistent.
- Temperature deviation needs assessment.
- Product identity is uncertain.
- Certification claim is uncertain.
- Security concern is unresolved.
- Supplier status is unclear.
- Testing is pending.
- Rejection decision is being evaluated.

Held product shall be physically segregated where practical and identified in the system or manual register. No held product may be processed, shipped, used, relabeled, reworked, or released without written QA authorization.

16.4 Rejection

Product shall be rejected when mandatory requirements are not met and the risk cannot be controlled. Rejection reasons may include:

- Unapproved supplier or unauthorized vessel without approved exception.
- Product unsafe or suspected unsafe.
- Decomposition, contamination, adulteration, or severe quality failure.
- Significant temperature abuse.
- Missing or false traceability.
- Incorrect species or suspected substitution.
- Invalid certification claim.
- Broken seal or security issue affecting product integrity.
- Regulatory document failure.
- Customer-prohibited condition.
- Product outside agreed specification with no approved disposition.

Rejected product shall be labeled, segregated, recorded, and dispositioned according to QA, Operations, Procurement, Legal/Compliance, and supplier agreement requirements.

17. Nonconformity and Corrective Action

All receiving nonconformities shall be recorded. The record shall include:

- Date and time.
- Supplier and source.
- Product and lot information.
- Quantity affected.
- Description of issue.
- Evidence, such as photos, temperature readings, labels, documents, or inspection notes.
- Immediate action taken.
- Product status.
- Person reporting.
- QA decision.
- Supplier notification where applicable.
- Corrective action required.
- Final disposition.

Recurring supplier issues shall be escalated to Procurement and QA for supplier performance review. Corrective actions may include supplier warning, increased inspection, additional documentation, corrective action request, suspension, removal from approved supplier list, revised specification, training, contract review, or change in sourcing.

18. Special Controls for Certified or Customer-Specific Product

Product carrying MSC, customer sustainability, origin, social compliance, organic, export, or other certification claims shall receive additional verification before acceptance.

Minimum controls include:

- Supplier is eligible to supply certified or customer-specific product.
- Certification documents are current and match the product.
- Lot identity supports claim.
- Labels and records do not overstate claim.
- Certified and non-certified product are segregated.
- Traceability records support mass balance where applicable.
- Any uncertainty results in hold until resolved.

If certified status cannot be verified, product shall not be received, processed, labeled, shipped, or sold as certified. It may be accepted only as non-certified if QA, Traceability, Procurement, and customer requirements allow that disposition.

19. Food Safety Hazard Considerations

Receiving inspection shall consider seafood-specific hazards, including:

- Histamine formation in susceptible species.
- Pathogenic microorganisms due to temperature abuse or contamination.
- Parasites.
- Chemical contamination from fuel, cleaning agents, lubricants, residues, or environmental exposure.
- Heavy metals or contaminants where applicable to species and source.
- Allergens and cross-contact.
- Foreign matter.
- Decomposition.

- Species substitution.
- Illegal, unreported, or unregulated sourcing risk.
- Poor sanitation during harvest, transport, landing, or handling.

The Food Safety Coordinator shall determine when product requires testing, enhanced inspection, hold, rejection, or supplier investigation.

20. Hygiene, Safety, and Unloading Controls

Receiving personnel shall follow BSF-HSE-001 — Workplace Safety Procedure and applicable hygiene rules during unloading and inspection.

Minimum controls include:

- Required PPE is worn.
- Hands are washed or sanitized according to site rules.
- Personnel do not eat, drink, smoke, or store personal items in receiving areas.
- Product is protected from floor contact, pests, splash, fumes, and chemicals.
- Unloading equipment is clean and safe.
- Damaged pallets, unstable loads, or unsafe stacking are corrected.
- Cold-room doors are managed to reduce temperature loss.
- Slips, trips, cuts, crush risks, manual handling risks, and forklift movement are controlled.
- Spills, leaks, ice, packaging waste, or broken product are cleaned promptly.

If unsafe conditions exist, receiving may be paused until the risk is controlled.

21. Records

The following records may be generated through this procedure:

Record	Owner	Minimum Retention
Receiving Inspection Record	Receiving Supervisor / QA	According to document retention policy
Temperature Receiving Record	Receiving / QA	According to cold-chain and food safety retention requirements
Product Hold Record	QA	Until final disposition and retention period are met

Record	Owner	Minimum Retention
Rejection Record	QA / Procurement	According to supplier and nonconformity retention requirements
Supplier Corrective Action Record	QA / Procurement	According to supplier performance policy
Traceability Verification Record	Traceability Officer	According to traceability and certification requirements
MSC or Certification Evidence	Traceability Officer / QA	According to certification requirements
Security Seal Verification Record	Security / Receiving	According to BASC or security retention rules
Photographic Evidence	QA / Operations	Linked to inspection, nonconformity, or supplier file
Laboratory Sample Record	QA / Food Safety	According to testing and food safety requirements

Records shall be legible, complete, accurate, dated, attributable, and protected from unauthorized modification. Corrections shall not obscure the original entry and shall identify the person making the correction.

22. Key Performance Indicators

BSF shall monitor receiving performance using relevant indicators, such as:

KPI	Definition	Target or Review Expectation
Receiving inspection completion rate	Percentage of received lots with completed inspection records before release	100%
Temperature compliance rate	Percentage of received lots within required temperature limits	Reviewed monthly

KPI	Definition	Target or Review Expectation
Product hold rate	Percentage of received lots placed on hold	Reviewed for trend and root cause
Rejection rate	Percentage of received lots rejected	Reviewed by supplier and reason
Documentation discrepancy rate	Percentage of lots with incomplete or inconsistent documentation	Reviewed monthly
Traceability completeness rate	Percentage of lots with complete traceability fields	100% for released product
Supplier recurring issue rate	Number of repeated nonconformities by supplier	Reviewed in supplier performance meetings
Certified product verification rate	Percentage of certified lots with verified claim before release	100%
Receiving delay due to non-readiness	Delays caused by internal readiness issues	Reviewed for operational improvement

KPIs shall be used to identify training needs, supplier performance issues, process weaknesses, documentation gaps, cold-chain risks, and improvement opportunities.

23. Risk and Control Matrix

Risk	Possible Impact	Required Control
Unapproved supplier accepted	Legal, quality, food safety, or customer noncompliance	Supplier approval check before receipt
Unauthorized vessel accepted	Traceability, legal, sustainability, or MSC claim failure	Verify against BSF-OPS-002
Species mismatch	Mislabeling, fraud, customer noncompliance	Verify against BSF-OPS-003 and documentation
Temperature abuse	Food safety risk, quality loss, rejection	Immediate temperature check and hold decision

Risk	Possible Impact	Required Control
Missing documentation	Loss of traceability or legal noncompliance	Hold product until resolved
Broken transport seal	Cargo security risk	Security escalation and product hold
Product contamination	Food safety risk	Reject or hold for QA assessment
Certified and non-certified mixing	Chain-of-custody failure	Physical and record segregation
Incomplete records	Audit finding and weak product defense	Mandatory receiving record completion
Commercial pressure to bypass controls	Unsafe or noncompliant product release	QA release authority and stop-work escalation

24. Training and Competence

Personnel involved in seafood receiving shall be trained before working independently. Training shall cover:

- This procedure.
- Receiving records and required documentation.
- Species identification basics.
- Temperature measurement.
- Product quality and freshness indicators.
- Food safety hazards relevant to seafood.
- Product hold and rejection rules.
- Traceability and lot coding.
- Certification claim control.
- Hygiene and PPE requirements.
- Cargo security awareness.
- Escalation and incident reporting.

Refresher training shall be provided when procedures change, audit findings occur, recurring errors are identified, new species are introduced, certification requirements change, or new personnel are assigned to receiving tasks.

25. Internal References

This procedure shall be used together with the following BSF documents:

- BSF-CORP-001 — Corporate Profile.
- BSF-CORP-002 — Corporate Glossary.
- BSF-DOC-STD-001 — Corporate Document Standard.
- BSF-CORP-003 — Corporate Organization Chart.
- BSF-CORP-004 — Corporate Knowledge Map.
- BSF-HR-001 — Employee Onboarding Guide.
- BSF-HR-002 — Employee FAQ.
- BSF-HR-003 — Leave and Benefits Policy.
- BSF-HSE-001 — Workplace Safety Procedure.
- BSF-HSE-002 — Emergency Response Guide.
- BSF-OPS-001 — Cold Chain Control Register.
- BSF-OPS-002 — Authorized Fishing Vessels.
- BSF-OPS-003 — Seafood Species Catalog.
- BSF-QMS-001 — Quality Management Induction.
- BSF-QMS-002 — Certification and Compliance Overview.
- BSF-QMS-003 — Corrective Action and Nonconformity Procedure.
- BSF-IT-001 — BlueTrack User Manual.
- BSF-IT-002 — Corporate Systems Access Guide.
- BSF-INV-001 — Document Inventory.
- BSF-INV-002 — Document Ownership Matrix.
- BSF-INV-003 — Document Sources and Ingestion Plan.
- BSF-INV-004 — Document Curation and Quality Criteria.
- BSF-INV-005 — Access and Permissions Policy.

26. Appendices

Appendix A — Minimum Receiving Checklist

Checkpoint	Result	Notes
Supplier approved	Pass / Fail / Hold	Confirm supplier status before unloading.
Vessel or source authorized	Pass / Fail / Hold	Verify against authorized list where applicable.

Checkpoint	Result	Notes
Purchase order matches delivery	Pass / Fail / Hold	Check species, quantity, presentation, and date.
Documents complete	Pass / Fail / Hold	Hold if required documents are missing.
Vehicle and seal acceptable	Pass / Fail / Hold	Escalate broken seal or tampering signs.
Product temperature acceptable	Pass / Fail / Hold	Record readings and method.
Product identity confirmed	Pass / Fail / Hold	Verify common and scientific name where required.
Product condition acceptable	Pass / Fail / Hold	Inspect odor, appearance, texture, packaging, and contamination signs.
Labels accurate	Pass / Fail / Hold	Confirm lot, species, weight, date, and certification claim.
Traceability complete	Pass / Fail / Hold	Do not release product without traceability.
Certification verified	Pass / Fail / Not Applicable	Required for MSC or customer-specific claims.
Final receiving decision recorded	Accepted / Conditional / Hold / Rejected	QA approval required for exceptions.

Appendix B — Standard Receiving Decision Guide

Finding	Initial Status	Escalation
All checks compliant	Accept	Receiving Supervisor
Minor packaging damage, product unaffected	Conditional or Hold	QA
Missing non-critical document	Hold	Procurement and QA
Missing traceability document	Hold or Reject	QA and Traceability

Finding	Initial Status	Escalation
Temperature deviation	Hold	QA and Food Safety
Product decomposition signs	Reject or Hold	QA and Food Safety
Species mismatch	Hold or Reject	QA, Traceability, Procurement
Broken seal or suspected tampering	Security Hold	Security and Supply Chain Security Coordinator
Invalid certification claim	Hold or receive as non-certified only if approved	QA and Traceability
Unapproved supplier	Reject unless approved exception	Procurement and QA

Appendix C — Receiving Record Minimum Fields

The receiving record shall include, at minimum:

- Document code or form reference.
- Receiving date.
- Receiving time.
- Supplier name.
- Supplier code where applicable.
- Vessel, farm, production site, or source reference.
- Transport unit identification.
- Seal number where applicable.
- Product name.
- Scientific name where required.
- Species catalog reference.
- Presentation.
- Quantity received.
- Weight received.
- Lot or batch number.
- Temperature readings.
- Inspection results.
- Documentation status.
- Traceability status.
- Certification status.

- Product decision.
- Product hold or rejection reference where applicable.
- Inspector name.
- Supervisor or QA approval where required.

27. Revision History

Version	Date	Description of Change	Prepared By	Reviewed By	Approved By
1.0	To be confirmed	Initial draft for review	Operations / QA Documentation Team	Operations Manager; QA Manager; Food Safety Coordinator; Traceability Officer	General Manager